Case Study

▼ Table of contents

- About Nonprofit 💼
- Project Objective 🌟
- Project Demo Video 🎥
- Link to Figma Prototype 🚀
- Process 💭
  - Design 🎨
    - User Testing
  - Development 💻
    - **Teamwork Networking**
- **Client Engagement**
  - Technical Approach
- Results 💯
- Testimonials 📩
- Meet the Team 💌

About Nonprofit 💼

The TAR Syndrome Association is a nonprofit dedicated to raising awareness of Thrombocytopenia-Absent Radius (TAR) Syndrome and supporting individuals and families affected by this rare condition. The organization promotes education, advocacy, community connection, and access to reliable resources while fostering inclusion, understanding, and empowerment.

Project Objective 🌟

The existing website needed clearer organization, easier navigation, and more accessible information for patients, families, and healthcare professionals. Redesigned and reorganized the website while retaining existing information and adding new educational, support, research, and engagement resources. Improvements on the accessibility and user-friendliness of the website that serves as a central hub for TAR Syndrome community. Offers community support, research, advocacy, and secure donations for the association.

Project Demo Video 🎥

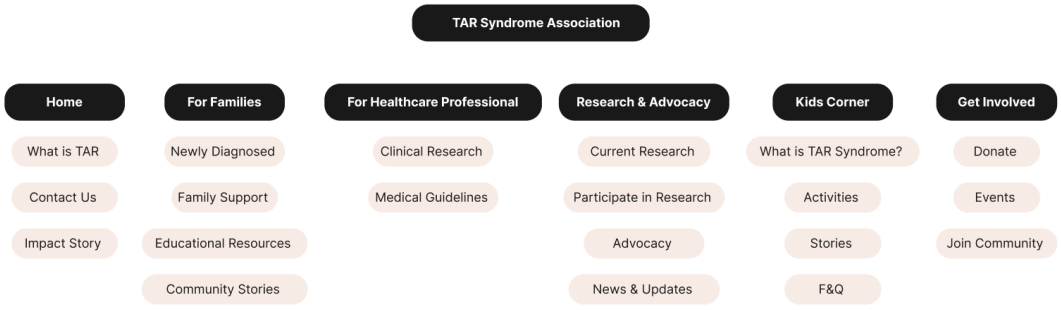
https://drive.google.com/file/d/1XfvYHaPf7×6QNfpZ3Nd7UHCmRaUSUlEB/view?usp=share_link

Link to Figma Prototype 🚀

https://www.figma.com/design/6lSIWLMwgVW2YDPwo0hEWa/TAR-Syndrome-Association-Web-design?node-id=480-55&p=f&t=LInehllnGuP1wm1j-0

Process 💭

Our designs first started with identifying new pages and defining what topics we wanted to cover. Our information architecture included a home page, a page for families, a page for healthcare professionals, a page for research and advocacy, a page for children and young adolescents who want to learn more about TAR Syndrome, a page to get involved, and a contact page.



Then, we moved to establishing a design system, where we decided on five colors [#002CFF, #FFFFFF, #000000, #FFA500, #EFBF04], typography of choice (Playfair Display, Source Serif Pro), and icons from the SqaureUp site directly (such as social media icons like Instagram and Facebook).

Design 🎨

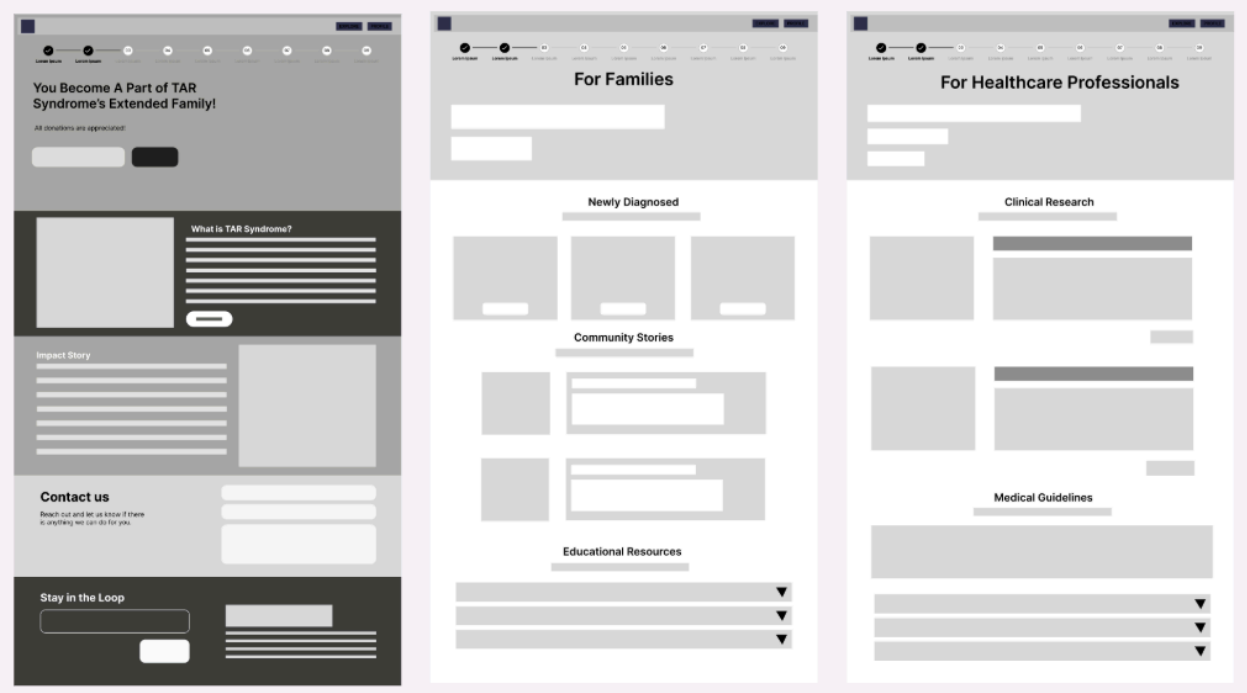
User Research

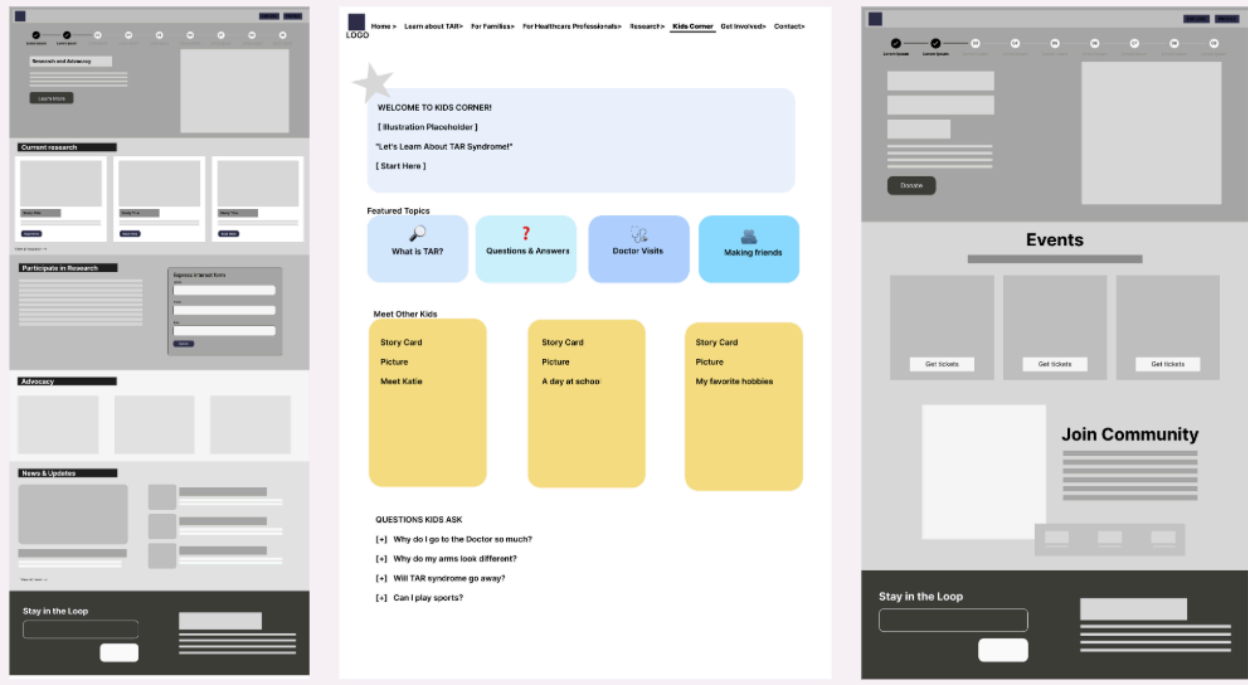
For research, we reviewed five different websites for inspiration, and to see how medical conditions and disabilities are presented on a physical site.

- cdc.gov - the layout of the site has a cohesive theme and enough spacing with features such as current studies, research updates, volunteer opportunities, and donations.
- rarediseases.org - provides a card layout with medical information structured in an informative way.
- limbs4kids.org - provides information on children and adolescents with medical disabilities (loss of limbs, prosthetics)
- health.harvard.edu - has different sections (articles, conditions, health), and spaces information in a digestible way.
- medscape.com - structured and clean layout, provides informative articles

Lo-fi

Our low-fidelity designs were intended to layout our initial thoughts and brainstorms. We mainly stuck to utilizing boxes, shapes, and different color sections. Our main focus was to get feedback from our client regarding the layout and structure of the information on each page before moving further.

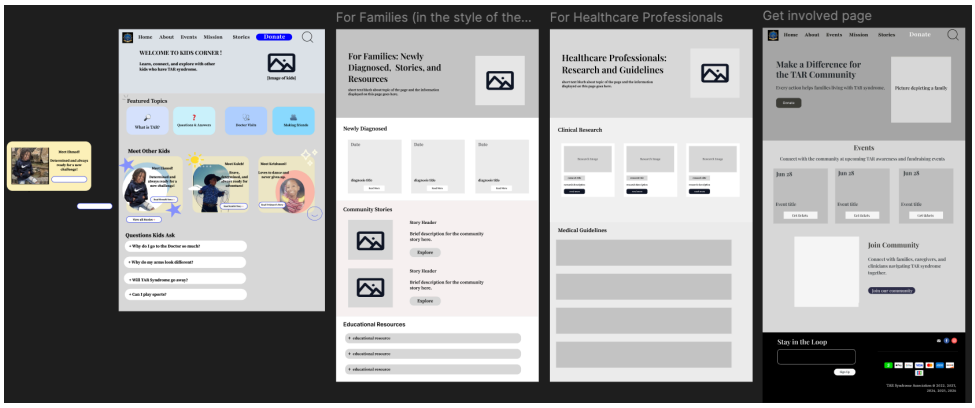


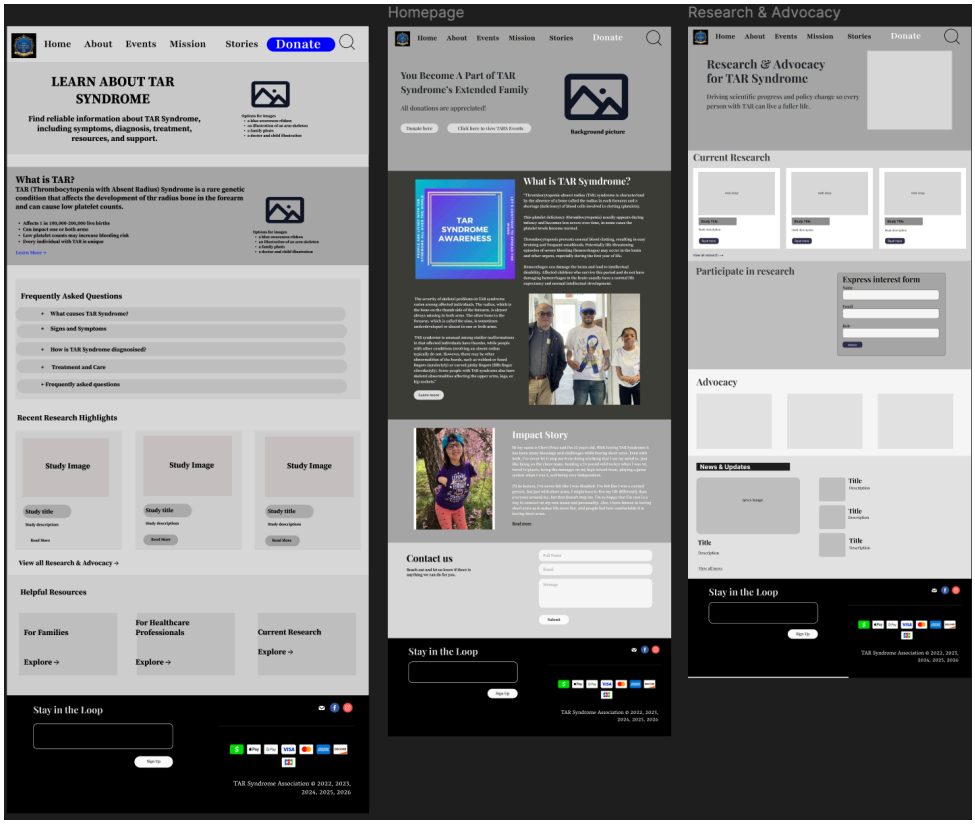


Mid-fi

Our mid-fidelity prototypes included more detail, without being too identical to the original site. More detail and color was added for some pages, as well as images and more descriptive text to indicate which feature (such as a card layout, different

sections, different buttons) are used for. Feedback from the client was received after our meetings, and we incorporated them for this iteration.



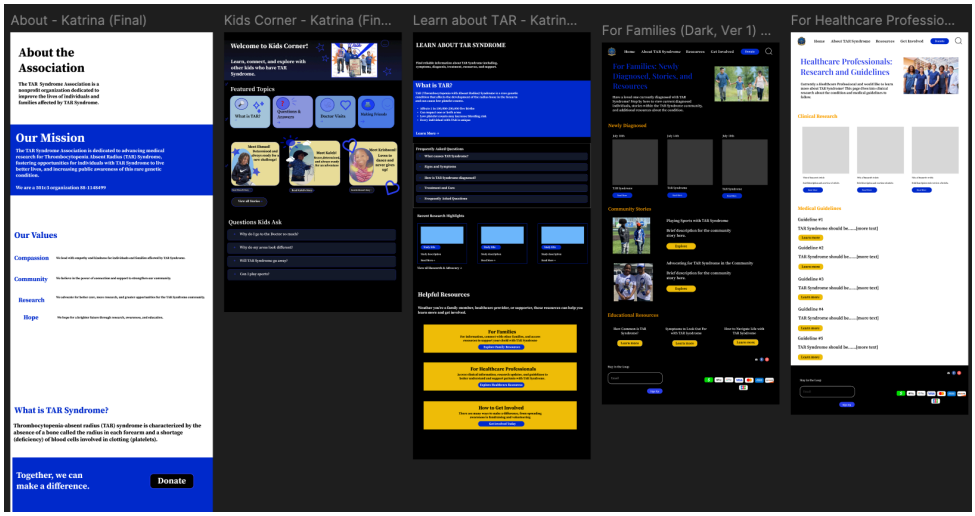


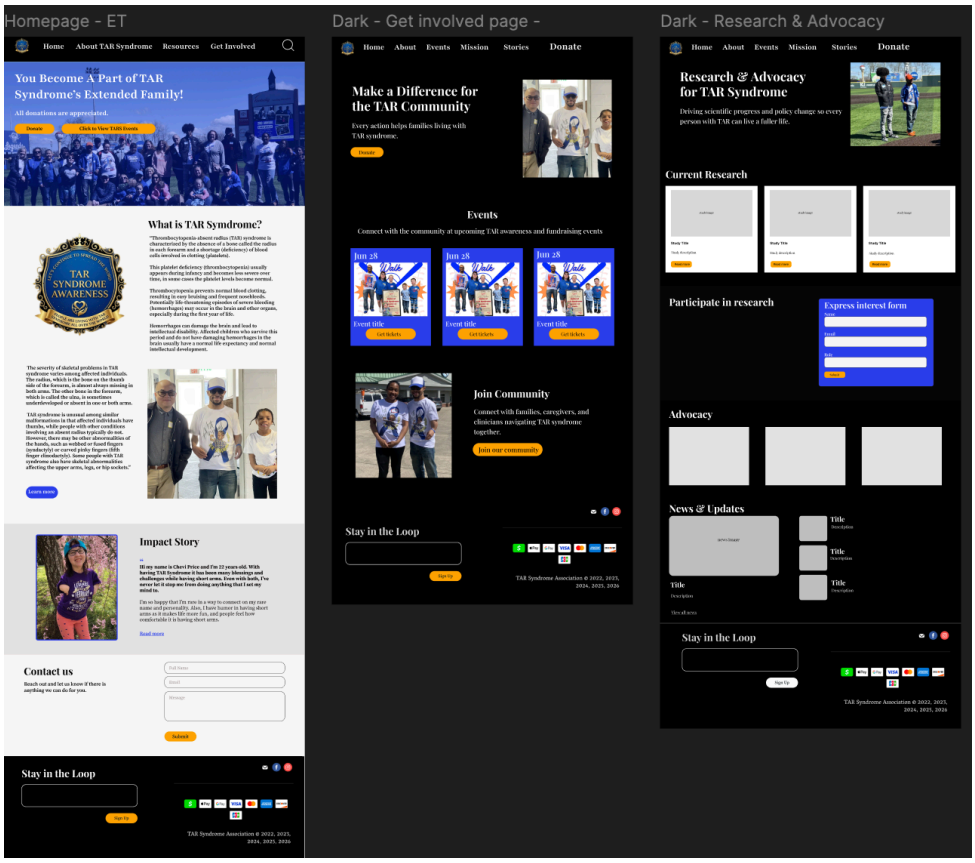
Hi-fi

Our high-fidelity prototype is our closest design to how the client would visualize the site to be. The most detail has been included, with images from the client, colors from our initial design system, and detailed text about TAR Syndrome, mission, values, questions, and other relevant information.

Here, we also included one additional page, Learn about TAR, after identifying that more information would be helpful to people who use the site to learn more about the condition, seek community, and engage with resources.

Before finalizing our high fidelity prototypes, we engaged in user testing with three users that provided direct feedback on each implemented page on the website. We incorporated the most standout feedback, such as color contrast, readability with different font sizing and headings, and organization within sections. The use of more images from the TAR Syndrome nonprofit themselves was included, in order to make the site feel more personable and familiar to future users.



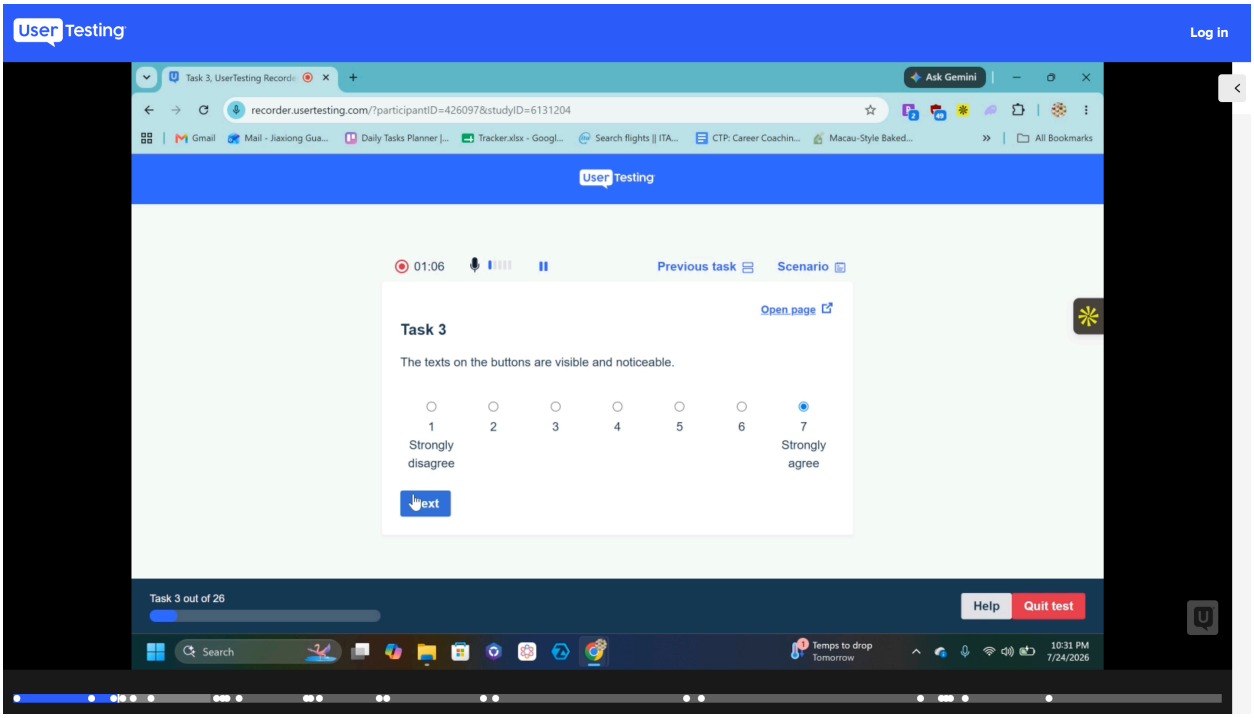


User Testing

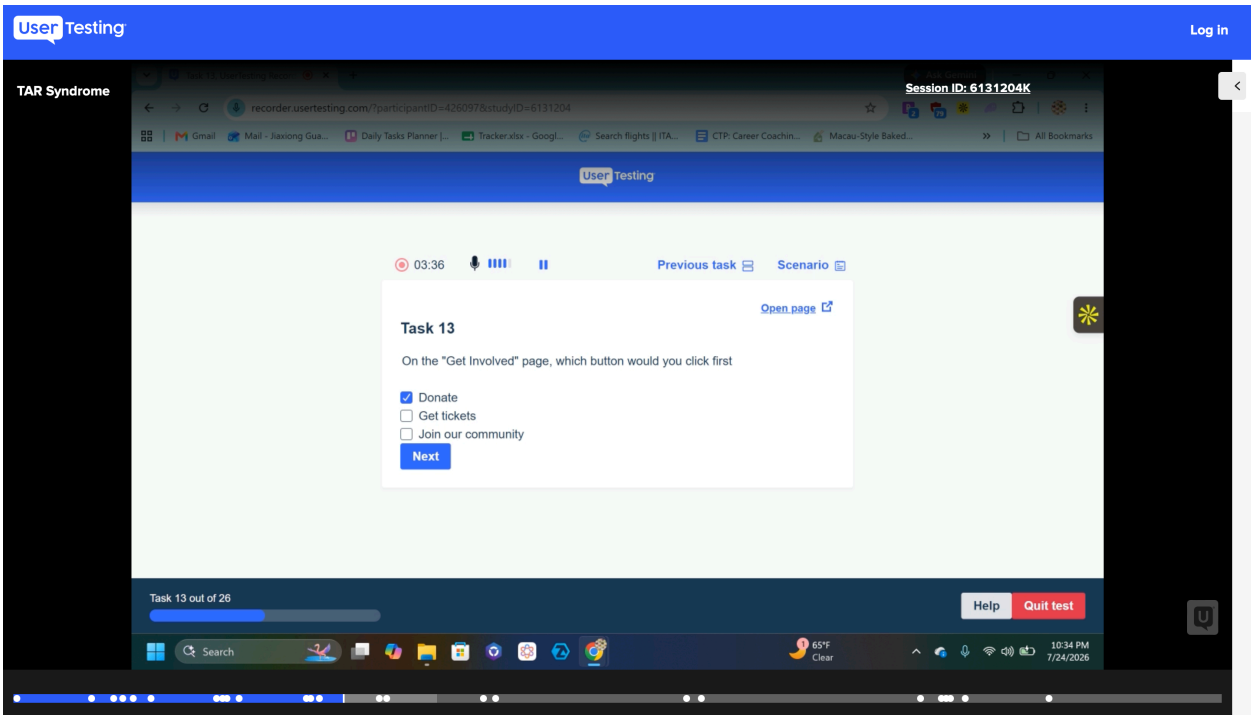
User testing feedback helped us identify areas where the designs could be more accessible, readable, and intuitive for different users. The feedback helped us move beyond the visual appearance of the designs and focus more closely on usability and how users actually experience the website.

- We conducted **accessibility testing** using Lighthouse to evaluate areas such as color contrast. These results, along with user feedback, guided adjustments to text colors, button visibility, and content hierarchy to create a more accessible experience.
- Feedback encouraged us to improve **readability**, particularly through font sizing, spacing, and reducing information density where content felt overwhelming.
- We also reviewed the **layout and visual hierarchy** of each page so that sections were clearly organized and users could easily scan and understand the content.
- We considered **font styles and sizes** to create clear distinctions headings, subheadings, questions, answers, and body text.

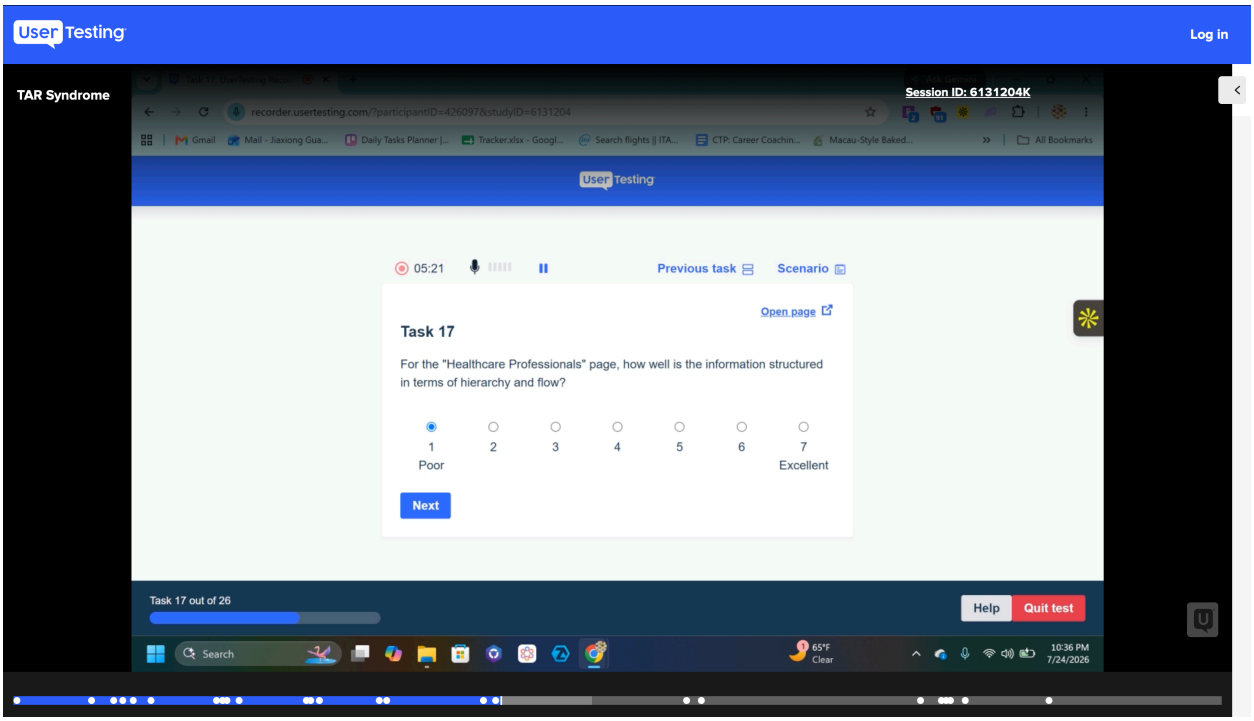
- Improved the **navigation bar** so that page options were labeled and organized more clearly, making it easier for users to understand how to get to the page they are looking for and how to move between pages and resources.



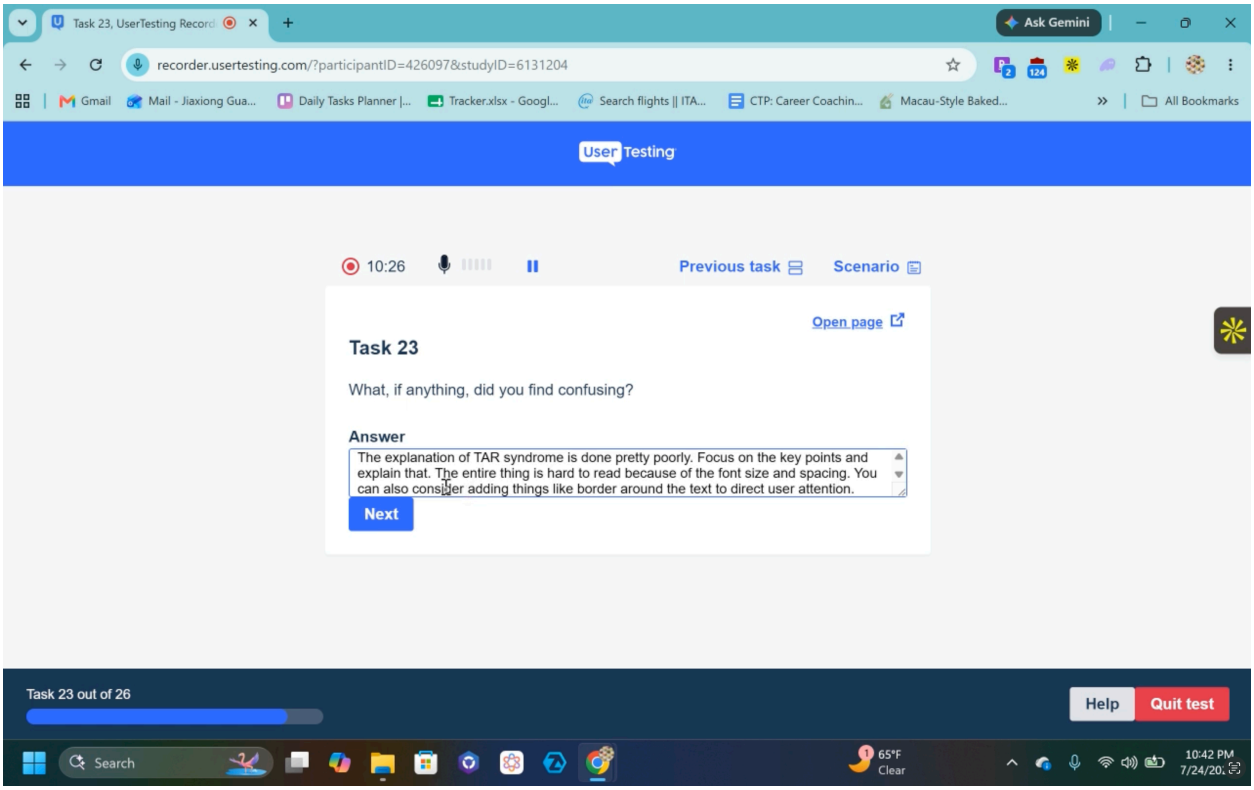
Button Visibility: The tester strongly agreed that button text was visible and noticeable, validating our use of clear labels and prominent interactive elements.



Call-to-Action Hierarchy: The tester selected “Donate” as their first action, indicating that the primary donation call-to-action was clearly identifiable.



Information Hierarchy: Testing revealed difficulty with the structure and flow of healthcare information, encouraging us to reorganize content and create clearer distinctions between sections.



Readability & Content: User feedback identified issues with information density, font sizing, and spacing, leading us to simplify content and improve readability and visual hierarchy.

Development 💻

Project Plan Scope of Work

Once requirements are sufficiently defined, the Project Plan translates the PRD into actionable design and engineering work.

The Project Plan includes:

1. Define website pages, navigation, and feature priorities.

2. Assign designers and engineers to specific pages and development responsibilities.
3. Research Squareonline capabilities and technical limitations.
4. Develop the Information Architecture and Design System.
5. Create Low-Fi designs.
6. Build corresponding Squareonline page skeletons.
7. Develop Mid-Fi designs and conduct engineering feasibility reviews.
8. Present designs and implementation progress to the client.
9. Develop High-Fi designs.
10. Implement approved designs in Squareonline .
11. Complete functional integrations such as donation security, Mailchimp, and SEO.
12. Test and refine the website based on client and team feedback.
13. Finalize the website for client approval and launch.

The Timeline Notes

Phase 1 — Project Discovery & Requirements

Milestone: Client goals, target users, functional priorities, and technical requirements identified.

The team begins by reviewing the TAR Syndrome Association's existing website, Notion documentation, and organizational goals. Client meetings are used to define the website's intended audiences, desired user actions, accessibility expectations, and overall measures of success.

Phase 2 — PRD Refinement & Project Planning

Milestone: PRD requirements refined and translated into an actionable Project Plan.

The team reviews and improves the initial PRD by converting broad client needs into specific functional requirements. The project manager distributes sections among team members, asks the team to identify missing information, and gathers additional questions for the client.

Phase 3 — Technical Scoping

Milestone: Major platform constraints, development risks, and implementation options identified.

Engineers familiarize themselves with the client's existing Squareonline environment before making changes. At the same time, the team evaluates whether proposed functionality can realistically be implemented within the platform.

Phase 4 — Information Architecture & Design System

Milestone: Website page hierarchy, navigation structure, and initial design standards established.

The team defines how users will navigate through the website and how major content areas will be organized.

Phase 5 — Low-Fidelity Design

Milestone: Initial wireframes completed for the core website pages.

Designers create Low-Fidelity layouts to define the basic structure and information placement of each page before detailed styling is introduced.

Phase 6 — Squareonline Skeleton Development

Milestone: Core website page structure created inside Squareonline.

Engineers begin translating the approved Information Architecture and Low-Fidelity designs into the actual Squarespace environment.

Phase 7 — Mid-Fidelity Design & Engineering Feasibility Review

Milestone: Detailed designs produced and validated against Squareonline capabilities.

The project progresses from Low-Fidelity to Mid-Fidelity design. Mid-Fi designs add greater visual and functional details.

Phase 8 — Client Review

Milestone: Major page designs and implementation progress reviewed by the client and project stakeholders.

The team presents Mid-Fidelity designs and development progress to the client. Client comments are incorporated into subsequent iterations.

Rather than immediately treating designs as complete, the project manager directs the team to continue improving the same assigned pages based on feedback and engineering comments.

Phase 9 — High-Fidelity Design & Squareonline Implementation

Milestone: Approved designs translated into near-final website pages.

Selected pages move into High-Fidelity design, representing the intended final visual appearance and functionality more closely.

Phase 10 — Functional Integrations

Milestone: Supporting website functionality integrated or validated.

Parallel engineering work focuses on major functional requirements beyond visual page implementation.

Phase 11 — Testing & Final Refinement

Milestone: Website reviewed against client requirements and remaining issues resolved.

The team reviews the completed site and makes final revisions based on the PRD, Project Plan, engineering findings, and client feedback.

Phase 12 — Final Approval

Milestone: Final Squareonline website completed and prepared for publication.

After remaining revisions and client approval, the completed website is prepared for launch.

The final product is expected to reflect the approved requirements, design system, page architecture, accessibility goals, SEO priorities, donation pathways, and other functionality developed throughout the project.

Teamwork Networking

Communication Tools Used:

- **Zoom**
  - Weekly client meetings
    - Involved client in website design creation
    - Updated client with design changes and constraints
    - Noted client wants and needs
    - Provided client prototype testing of product
  - Weekly internal team meetings
    - Reviewed client wants and needs

        - Formed weekly tasks for designers and engineers
        - Q&A opportunity between designers, engineers, TM, PM, and mentor.
- **Slack**
    - Text communication between team members
        - PM provides weekly meeting recap
        - PM delegates weekly tasks for designers and engineers based on meetings
        - TM may delegate tasks for engineers
        - Designers provide updates on design changes
        - Engineers provide updates on design implementation
        - Mentor provides assistance when requested

Client Engagement

- Inputs feedback during the client meetings
- Great communication during email responses and slack communication
- Gave feedback on what changes needed to be made during each project phase
- Listed creative ideas on how to develop/revamp the project so that each member of the team is able to work consistently together

Technical Approach

Tools Used:

- Documentation: Notion, Google Sheets
- Design: Figma, Usertesting
- Implementation: Square, Mailchimp, Google Lighthouse tool

Usertesting

1. First briefly describe how you know about TAR Syndrome Association in 1 sentence. Optionally include your age or age range.
2. Looking through the homepage, which section caught your attention first?
    - The headline pictures with texts

- “What is TAR Syndrome?” text block
- the impact Story/photos

3. The texts on the buttons are visible and noticeable
    - Rating Scale: Strongly disagree (1) - Strongly agree (7)
4. Scroll up to the top of the Homepage, and move onto the next step
5. Find where a subpage called “Kids’s Corner” would be in the navigation bar at the top. Think out loud as you do so.
6. What three words would you use to describe that experience?
7. Rate your level of agreement with this statement: “I completed that task successfully
    - Rating Scale: Strongly disagree (1) - Strongly agree (7)
8. Rate your level of agreement with this statement: “It was easy to complete the task”
    - Rating Scale: Strongly disagree (1) - Strongly agree (7)
9. What, if anything, did you find confusing?
    - [Written response]
10. Which section or parts would you click first: Featured topics, meet other kids, or questions kids ask? Why?
11. How easy is the text on the “Featured Topics” and “Meet other Kids” story cards to read against the colored backgrounds?
    - Rating Scale: Not at all clear (1) - Very clear(7)
12. Navigate to the “Get Involved” page by clicking the text on the navigation bar at the top. When you see the page, move onto the next step.
13. On the “Get Involved” page, which button would you click first
14. Navigate to the “For Families” page by clicking the text on the navigation bar at the top. When you see the page, move onto the next step.
15. Scrolling through the “For Families” page, which section grabbed your attention first?
    - Newly diagnosed
    - Community Stories

- Educational resources

16. Navigate to the “Healthcare Professionals” page by hovering over “Resources” on the navigation bar at the top. When you see the page, move onto the next step
17. For the “Healthcare Professionals” page, how well is the information structured in terms of hierarchy and flow?
18. Go back to the homepage, Once the homepage fully loads, move onto the next step.
19. Scenario: You visited this page because you had never heard of and want to learn about TAR Syndrome. Try to navigate to pages to find more information on it. Think out loud as you do so.
20. What three words would you use to describe that experience?
21. Rate your level of agreement with this statement: “I completed that task successfully.”
    - Rating Scale: Strongly disagree (1) - Strongly agree (7)
22. Rate your level of agreement with this statement: “It was easy to complete the task”
    - Rating Scale: Strongly disagree (1) - Strongly agree (7)
23. What, if anything did you find confusing?
24. After exploring the website, how would you describe your trust in the organization and likihood to make a donation to or get involved with TAR Syndrome Association, increase, remian the same, or decrease?
    - Rating Scale: Decreased significantly (1) - Increased significantly (7)
25. What, if anything, made the donation or engagement/involvement with the TAR Syndrome Association process confusing? Why?

Techstack(No Code):

- Frontend & backend: Square

Results 💯

Over the course of our project, we further defined the branding of the Association and reconstructed the website to more effectively achieve their goals and cater to their target audience, people with TAR syndrome and the immediate caretakers of children

with TAR syndrome. The meaningful color palette is flexibly used throughout the website, with the differing yet consistent themes per page to best reflect the topics and content of each page. The minimal and concise style for information display was well received by our target users during user testing, earning praises for ease of navigation and intuitive information seeking. We received criticism on our design regarding layouts and style from non-target users, which we have acted on to make considerable improvements. We expect the clarity and reliability of resources and the organization's missions, as well as our SEO optimizations, will encourage donations to the organization in aid of Medical Research initiatives on the condition and help users seek out relevant information and find community.

The website currently still lacks actual content, including text and media for some sections, which will be provided and updated by the client after the program ends, following our instructions and guidelines.

Testimonials 💌

This can be a quote(s) from the client or users!

Jylan founder of the TAR Syndrome Association: The program was great, very beneficial, enhanced the website. The team was great, understood everything that was needed. The cause of the program helped understand more resources for funding and engagement. Having a team working for 16 weeks behind the scenes made it more possible for the TAR Syndrome Association to contribute and being able to connect and network with everyone has been great. Thank you for making this experience beneficial for not only me but for my team as well.

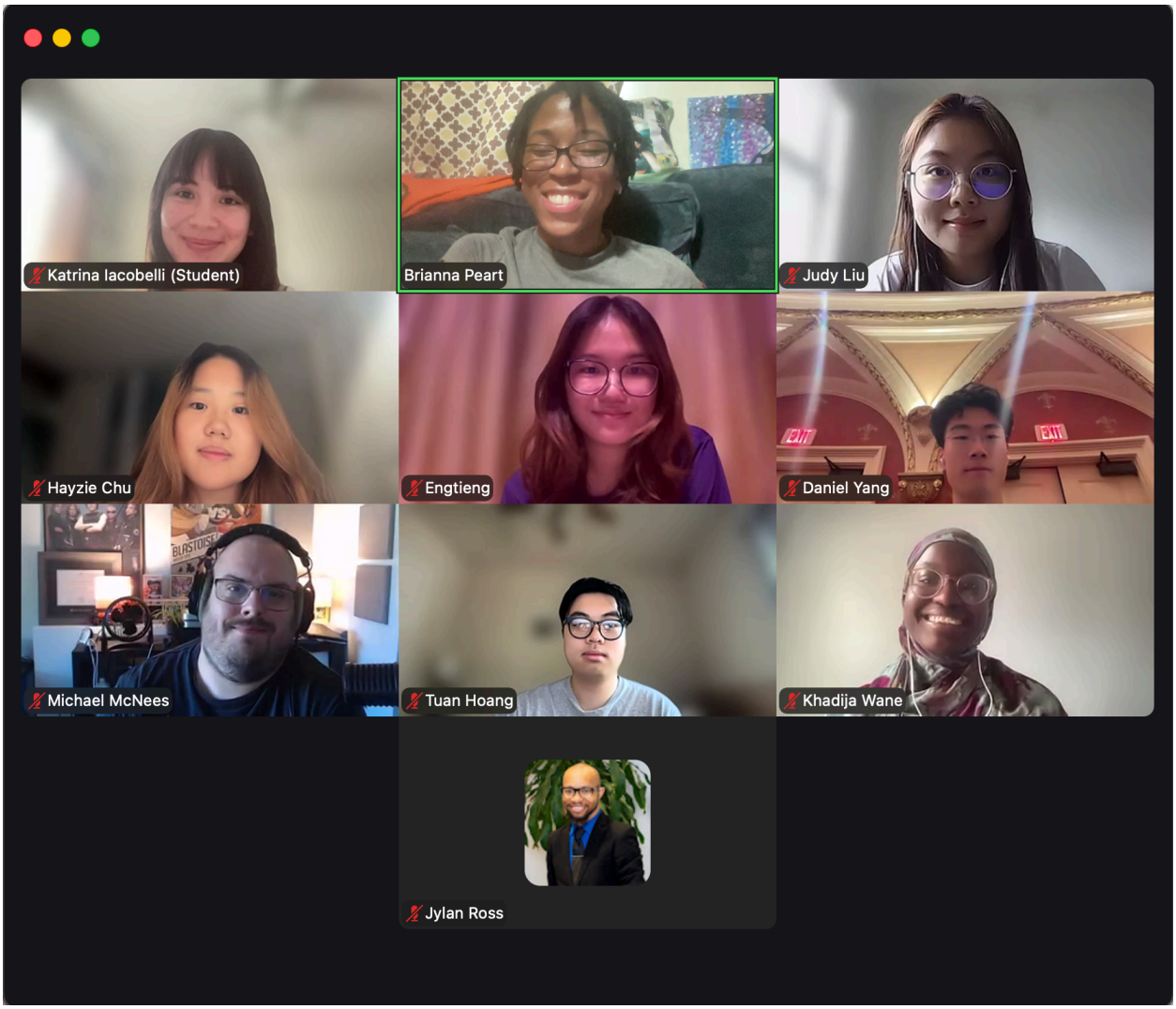
Meet the Team 💌

Product Manager: Hayzie Chu

Technical Manager: Brianna Peart

Developers: Judy Liu, Vivek Aher, Zhiyuan Yang, Tuan Hoang

Designers: Katrina Lacobelli, Khadija Wane, Engtieng Ourn



Slides: https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/1i8WI6IOyCHGfIGUjWuoTyQJESQzxDSPMiniS-gTg-LE/edit?usp=sharing